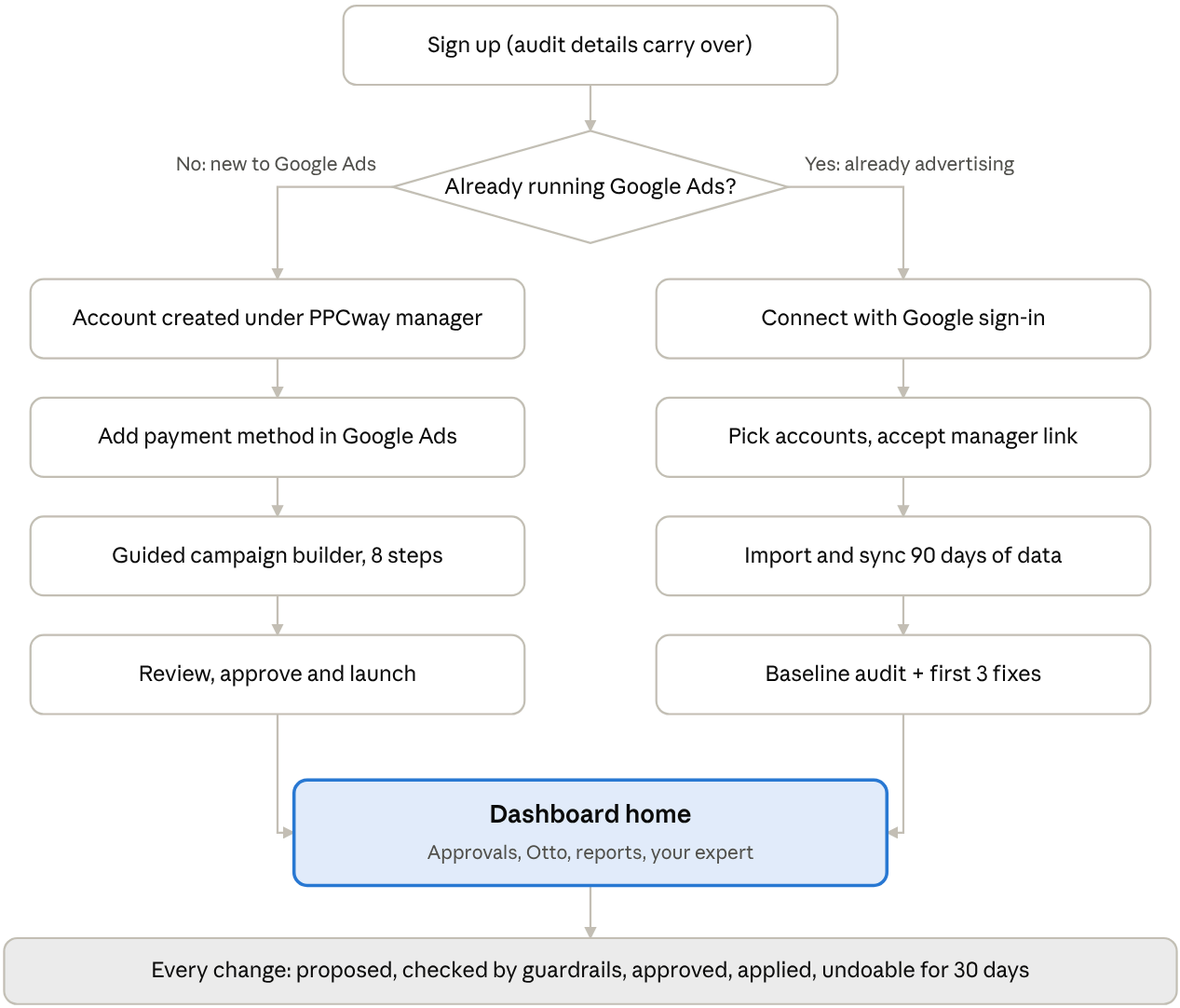
PPCway Dashboard Developer Requirements

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The dashboard has two entry paths that meet in one workspace: advertisers new to Google Ads launch a first campaign through a guided builder, and existing advertisers connect their account and manage it with Otto's recommendations and expert sign-off. Every change Otto or a user proposes goes through the same approval, guardrail and undo system before it reaches Google Ads.

At a glance

Two ways in, one dashboard



user paths · new and existing advertisers

New advertisers get an account created and a guided first campaign; existing advertisers connect and import. Both land in the same dashboard and the same change pipeline.

Scope and principles

The MVP covers Google Search campaigns, plus call and location assets, for one business per account on Starter and Growth and up to 10 client accounts on Agency. Performance Max, Demand Gen, Shopping and Display follow in later phases; YouTube reach comes

through Demand Gen and Performance Max, since YouTube-only Video campaigns cannot be created through the API.

The build extends the proof of concept on branch `poc-backend-spine`: the backend spine, the Google Ads gateway, the merchant console and the guardrail system. Real Google Ads integration, authentication and secrets handling are still outstanding there and are part of this scope.

Rules every feature follows:

- **The customer owns the Google Ads account.** PPCway works through delegated access. Ad spend is billed by Google to the customer's own payment method; PPCway never holds ad spend.
- **Nothing changes without a decision.** Every change, from Otto, a user or an expert, is a proposed change with a reason, an expected impact and an approval path.
- **Every change can be undone.** Each applied change stores the before state, so it can be reverted from the change history. Google Ads cannot restore removed campaigns, ads or keywords, so undoing a removal recreates them as new items without their history.
- **Hard spend limits.** A daily cap and a monthly cap per account, enforced by PPCway before any mutate call, independent of Google's own budgets. Google may spend up to twice the daily budget on a single day, so PPCway checks spend hourly and lowers budgets or pauses campaigns as a cap nears.
- **Plain language first.** Leads, cost per lead and calls lead the interface; Google Ads terms appear only in detail views and expert tools.
- **Same workspace for both paths.** A campaign built in PPCway and a campaign imported from Google Ads look and behave the same once live.

Onboarding and account connection

Onboarding asks one question early, "Do you already run Google Ads?", and routes to one of two setups. Data from the free audit carries over, so nobody types their business details twice.

- **Sign-up:** email and password or Google sign-in, email verification, plan choice with a trial or a first-month charge (decision open). Business name, category, address, phone and website pre-fill from the audit when the visitor came from it.
- **Path A, new to Google Ads:** PPCway creates a client account under the PPCway manager account in the customer's currency and time zone, then invites the customer as an admin so they own it. The customer adds a payment method in Google Ads

through a guided deep link; the dashboard detects billing status and blocks launch until it is active.

- **Path B, existing account:** the customer connects with Google sign-in (OAuth, `adwords` scope), picks the account or accounts to manage, and PPCway sends a manager-link request the customer accepts. Agency users link several client accounts.
- **First sync:** import account structure and 90 days of performance, run the baseline audit (the same 14 checks as the public audit, plus account-level checks), and show the first three recommendations within about 5 minutes.
- **Conversion tracking check:** detect existing conversion actions. If none exist, offer guided setup: a site tag and call tracking, with a step to send instructions to the customer's web person.
- **Expert match:** on Growth and Agency, assign a dedicated expert by region, language and industry, and show their profile and booking link on day one.
- **Disconnect:** the customer can revoke access at any time. Stored tokens are deleted; history and reports stay readable for the retention period.

New advertiser: campaign builder

A first-time advertiser goes from goal to a campaign ready for approval in about 15 minutes. Otto drafts every step from the business profile, and the user confirms or edits. Progress saves after each step so they can leave and come back.

Campaign types, step details by type and limitations: Campaign builder

1. **Goal:** calls, form leads, direction requests or online sales. This sets the conversion action and the bidding strategy.
2. **Services and offer:** pick the services to advertise from Otto's list (taken from the website and listing). Add a price point or offer if they have one.
3. **Where and when:** service area as radius or postal codes or cities, language, and an ad schedule that defaults to opening hours.
4. **Keywords:** Otto proposes ad groups by service, keywords with match types, and a starter negative-keyword list (jobs, free, DIY). Shows estimated monthly searches and cost per click ranges.
5. **Ads:** responsive search ads with 15 headlines and 4 descriptions drafted per ad group, plus callout, sitelink, call and location assets. A live preview and a policy and quality check run as the user edits.

6. **Budget and bidding:** a daily budget with the expected clicks and leads range, a monthly cap, and a starting strategy (Maximize Conversions, moving to Target CPA once there is enough conversion data).
7. **Tracking:** confirm the conversion action exists and fires. Launch is allowed without it only with a visible warning.
8. **Review and launch:** a one-page summary of the plan in plain language. On Growth and Agency, the expert signs off first (target turnaround under 1 business day). Launch creates everything in Google Ads, then shows the campaign as live or under review.

After launch, the campaign runs in a learning window of 14 to 21 days depending on its type (see Campaign builder): Otto watches daily, makes no bid changes, and sends a day-3 and day-7 check-in.

Existing advertiser: campaign management

Existing advertisers see their whole account in PPCway within minutes of connecting and can manage it there day to day. Changes made directly in Google Ads still show up, and PPCway never overwrites them silently.

- **Campaign list:** every campaign with status, budget, spend, clicks, conversions, cost per conversion and trend for the chosen date range. Filter by status and type; unsupported campaign types are read-only with a label.
- **Campaign detail:** tabs for overview, ad groups, keywords, search terms, ads and assets, locations and schedule, and change history.
- **Edits users can make:** pause, enable or remove campaigns, ad groups, ads and keywords; change budget and bidding strategy; add or edit keywords and match types; add negatives from search terms in one click; edit ads and assets; change locations and schedule.
- **Edit flow:** each edit becomes a proposed change with a before and after preview. It applies immediately for owners within guardrails, or goes to approval when it crosses a threshold (see Otto recommendations and approvals).
- **External changes:** the sync detects changes made outside PPCway, records them in the change history as “made in Google Ads”, and rebases any pending proposals on top of them.
- **Bulk actions:** select many keywords or ads to pause, enable or add as negatives.
- **Create another campaign:** existing advertisers can use the same builder as new advertisers, pre-filled from their account history.

Dashboard home and reporting

The home screen answers “Is it working, and what needs me?” in one view, for both paths.

Metric definitions, report types and the live Otto chat: Reporting and Otto chat

- **Results strip:** leads (calls plus forms), cost per lead, spend against budget, and change against the previous period. Account currency and the user’s language.
- **Needs you:** pending approvals, billing or policy problems, disapproved ads and tracking failures, most urgent first.
- **Otto activity:** what Otto checked today, what it changed under auto-approval, and what it is waiting on.
- **Visibility Score:** the audit score tracked over time, so customers see progress from the fixes they made.
- **Your expert:** name, next session, hours used this month and a message button.
- **Reports:** a weekly plain-language email every Monday, a monthly PDF, and on Agency a white-label version with the agency’s logo and domain.
- **Default metrics:** clicks, cost, impressions and conversions at account, campaign, ad group, ad and keyword level, plus the search terms view, so the reporting minimums in Google Ads API access and compliance are met.

Website audit (Free tools in the dashboard)

The free audit becomes a living audit inside the dashboard. It sits under Free tools, re-runs on its own as the website, listing and ads change, and always shows the latest results with their full history. Visitors who ran the public audit find their results carried over as the first entry when they sign up.

- **Where it lives:** dashboard navigation, Free tools, Website audit, next to the budget calculator, the cost per lead and ROAS estimator and the ad copy checker. The Visibility Score card on the dashboard home links straight to it.
- **What it checks:** the 14 public checks (Google listing, website, ads right now), plus in-app checks on every page the ads send people to, not only the homepage: mobile and desktop speed, broken pages, HTTPS and certificate expiry, tracking tag present and firing, call button and form present, and business name, address and phone matching the Google listing.
- **Always current:** each result shows when it was last checked and when the next check runs. A “Re-run now” button refreshes everything, limited to once an hour per account.

Trigger	What re-runs	How fast
Scheduled	Website checks daily; ads checks with each sync; listing checks weekly	Overnight in the account's time zone
Website change detected	Checks for the pages that changed	Within 1 hour of detection
User marks a fix as done	That check, with a before and after	Immediately
New or changed ad URL	Full check of the new page	Before the ad goes live
Listing change (hours, photos, reviews)	Listing checks	Within 1 hour
Re-run now	Everything	Results stream in as checks finish

What users see:

- The score out of 100, the three sub-scores, and the change since the last run.
- Each check with its status, what was found, why it matters, how to fix it, who can fix it (you, your web person or Otto) and the points it adds.
- "What changed since last time": issues fixed, new issues and score movement, each dated.
- A history chart of the score with markers where fixes landed and Otto made changes; every past run kept for 24 months.
- A page-by-page view of every landing page.
- "Send to my web person": a fix list by email with an expiring link that needs no login.

Alerts: urgent problems notify right away by email and in the app: site down, tracking stopped, certificate expiring within 14 days, hours removed from the listing. Score changes go into the weekly summary, and a fix that raises the score gets its own short note.

Connected to the rest of the dashboard: audit findings feed Otto's Diagnose stage, the Visibility Score appears in every report, and the Otto chat answers questions such as "What's my audit score and what should I fix next?".

By plan: website change detection runs daily on Starter and hourly on Growth and Agency. Agency runs a separate audit per client account. Pages checked per account: 50 on Starter, 200 on Growth and per client on Agency (starting limits to confirm).

Engineering notes:

- An audit service with a registry of checks; each check has an id, inputs, schedule, triggers, scoring weight and version. When a check's scoring rule changes, the score change is labelled "scoring updated" so it is never mistaken for a change on the site.
- A crawler that loads each landing page as a phone and as a desktop browser, with timeouts and per-account page limits. If a site blocks it, the audit says so and explains how to allow PPCway's checker.
- Change detection: a light daily fetch compares a fingerprint of each page's text and file sizes, plus the sitemap, to catch new and changed pages.
- Tracking verification loads the page in a headless browser and confirms the tag fires.
- Results are stored per run and per check, with a daily score series for the history chart.
- Only public pages are checked; PPCway never logs in to a customer's site.

Otto recommendations, approvals and guardrails

Otto runs a daily check on every account and turns what it finds into recommendations. Each one is a proposed change with a plain-language reason, the evidence, the expected impact and an undo plan. Users approve with one tap, and the approval route depends on the size of the change.

How Otto decides, the data points it uses and how it measures results:

Otto optimization engine

Change	Default route	Examples
Low risk	Auto-applied, reported in Otto activity (opt-in per account)	Add negative keywords from wasteful search terms, pause a disapproved ad
Medium risk	One-tap approval by the owner or an admin	Bid strategy target change under 20%, new ad variation, schedule change
High risk	Expert sign-off, then owner approval (on Starter, owner approval with a risk warning)	Budget change over 20%, new campaign, removing a campaign, bid strategy switch

- **Guardrails, checked before every write:** daily and monthly spend caps, maximum budget change per day, blocked keyword list, brand terms protected, no changes during the 14-day learning window except fixes.
- **Undo:** any applied change can be reverted from the change history within 30 days; the revert itself is logged as a change.
- **Explainability:** every recommendation names the data it used (date range, search terms, metrics) and links to the relevant view.
- **Thresholds are settings:** owners can tighten or loosen the routes above per account, within plan limits.
- **Model use:** Otto's drafts (ad text, keyword ideas, summaries) come from a language model behind a server-side service with prompt logging and policy filtering; the model never calls Google Ads directly. All writes go through the gateway and the guardrail system.

Expert in the loop

Growth and Agency customers get a dedicated expert who works inside PPCway, not in a separate tool. Experts need their own console and a clear record of time spent.

- **Expert console:** a queue of accounts assigned to them, items waiting for sign-off, flagged accounts and booked sessions.
- **Sign-off:** approve, reject or edit a high-risk change with a note the customer sees.
- **Sessions:** booking with the customer's time zone, a shared agenda and notes saved to the account.

- **Hours:** time is logged per task against the plan allowance (2 hours a month on Growth, 5 on Agency). Extra hours are billed at the regional hourly rate and need customer approval before they are used.
- **Access:** experts get role-based access to assigned accounts only, and every action they take is in the change history under their name.
- **Quality:** turnaround targets (sign-off within 1 business day) and customer ratings after each session feed expert performance reporting for PPCway staff.

Roles, plans and limits

Plan limits are enforced in the backend, not only hidden in the interface. The figures below match the pricing page; prices themselves come from the billing price book per currency.

Plan	Price (US / Canada, monthly)	Accounts	Ad spend managed per month	Expert hours included	Campaigns
Starter	$149 / C$199	1	up to $2,000 / C$2,500	0	1
Growth	$349 / C$499	1	up to $7,500 / C$10,000	2	Confirm limit
Agency	$949 / C$1,299	10, then a per-client fee	up to $40,000 / C$50,000	5	Confirm limit

Role	Can do
Owner	Everything, including billing, plan, disconnecting the account and approval thresholds
Admin	Approve and make changes, invite members; no billing
Member	View everything and propose changes; cannot approve
Expert (PPCway)	Work on assigned accounts, sign off high-risk changes, log hours
Client viewer (Agency)	View reports and results for their own account only

When spend passes the plan limit, the dashboard warns at 80% and suggests an upgrade at 100%; it never pauses campaigns because of a plan limit (open question below).

Data model

These are the core entities; Google Ads objects are mirrored locally for fast reads and history, with Google Ads remaining the source of truth for anything live.

Entity	Key fields	Notes
Organization	name, plan, billing customer, region, currency	One per paying customer or agency
User and Membership	email, auth identity, role per organization	Experts are users with an expert flag
Business profile	name, category, address, phone, website, hours, service area	Seeded from the free audit
Ads connection	Google customer id, manager link status, encrypted refresh token, scopes, status	One per connected or created Google Ads account
Campaign mirror	campaigns, ad groups, keywords, ads, assets, budgets, targeting	Synced; stores the resource name and last-synced version
Performance facts	date, entity, impressions, clicks, cost, conversions, value	Daily grain, kept 25 months
Proposed change	type, target entity, before, after, reason, evidence, risk, route, status	The unit of approval for Otto, users and experts
Applied change	proposed change id, actor, applied time, Google response, revert data	Immutable; powers history and undo
Guardrail policy	spend caps, change limits, blocked terms, thresholds	Per account, defaults from plan
Audit run	score, check results, recommendations	The public audit and in-app audits share this
Expert task and time entry	account, task type, minutes, notes	Feeds hours and billing

Integrations and services

Each integration sits behind its own service so it can be swapped or mocked in tests. The Google Ads gateway from the proof of concept stays the only path for reads and writes to Google Ads.

Integration	Used for	Notes
Google Ads API	Account creation under the manager account, campaign build, edits, reporting, change history	Through the gateway; batch mutates, partial-failure handling, quota-aware queues
Google sign-in (OAuth 2.0)	Connecting existing accounts; optional login	Offline access for refresh tokens; tokens encrypted with a managed key
Business listing and places data	Audit, business profile prefill	Already used by the audit's business search
Site checks	Speed, mobile and tracking-tag checks for the audit and Otto	Run server-side on a schedule
Language model	Otto drafts, summaries, recommendation text	Server-side only, with logging and policy filters
Billing	PPCway subscription, per-currency price book, expert hours, Agency per-client fees	Stripe or equivalent; never ad spend
Email	Verification, weekly reports, approvals, alerts	Transactional provider with templates per language
Scheduling	Expert sessions	Embedded booking or a booking provider
Product analytics and errors	Funnel, feature use, error tracking	Behind the cookie consent manager

Google Ads API access and compliance

PPCway needs Standard access on its developer token before it can serve real customers at scale, and Standard access brings Google's Required Minimum Functionality (RMF) rules for full-service tools. Apply early: Google says reviews can take days or weeks.

- **Access levels:** Explorer, Basic and Standard, each granted after review. RMF applies only to projects with Standard access, and a failed audit can bring non-compliance fees. (Access levels and RMF)

- **Creation features a full-service tool must offer:** campaigns with budget, location and language targeting; ad groups and keywords with match types; campaign-level negative keywords; at least one conversion tracking type; Target CPA, Target ROAS and Maximize Conversions bidding; callout assets. (Required minimum functionality)
- **Management features:** edit campaign settings; pause, enable and remove campaigns, ads and keywords; change bidding strategies.
- **Reporting features:** clicks, cost, impressions and conversions shown by default at customer, campaign, ad group, ad and keyword level, plus the search terms view, and status shown wherever paused or removed items appear.
- **Implication for the MVP:** the builder and campaign management above already cover these. Target ROAS and the search terms view must ship in the MVP even though most launch customers will not need them first.
- **Manager account:** PPCway runs one production manager account that owns API access; customer accounts link to it.

Non-functional requirements

- **Security:** OAuth refresh tokens and API secrets in a secrets manager or encrypted with a managed key, never in code or logs; least-privilege service accounts; MFA for PPCway staff and experts; audit log of every sign-in and every change.
- **Sync:** structure changes every 15 minutes, performance hourly for today and nightly for the previous 3 days (to pick up late conversions); manual refresh on demand.
- **API quota:** a per-account write queue with retries and backoff, batched mutates, and alerts when daily operations reach 80% of the token's limit.
- **Reliability:** a failed write never leaves a half-applied change; partial failures are shown per item with the Google error in plain language.
- **Performance:** dashboard home loads in under 2 seconds from the local mirror; no live Google Ads call on page load.
- **Privacy:** data processing agreement, regional data residency decision (open), deletion of account data within 30 days of a request.
- **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.2 AA, full keyboard use, screen-reader labels on charts and tables.
- **Localization:** account currency and time zone everywhere; interface strings ready for the 12 site languages, English first.

- **Mobile:** home, approvals and reports fully usable on phones; the builder works on phones but is designed desktop-first.
- **Observability:** structured logs, traces across gateway calls, and status-page components for app, sync, Otto and Google Ads connection.

Delivery phases

Build in four phases so real accounts are connected and read safely before PPCway writes anything to Google Ads. Each phase ends at a gate; dates are set once the team sizes the work.

Phase	Scope	Exit gate
1. Foundation	Auth, organizations and roles, secrets handling, real Google Ads connection through the gateway, Basic access token, sync and local mirror	5 internal accounts connected and synced for 7 days with no data mismatches
2. Read and recommend	Dashboard home, campaign list and detail, reporting, baseline audit, Otto recommendations shown but not applied	Pilot customers use it weekly; recommendation accuracy reviewed by the Google Ads consultant
3. Approve and write	Proposed changes, approvals, guardrails, undo, editing existing campaigns, expert console	30 days of pilot writes with zero guardrail breaches and every change revertible
4. New advertisers	Account creation under the manager account, billing deep link, campaign builder, learning mode, Standard access with RMF features complete	First 10 new advertisers launched end to end; Standard access approved

Phases 3 and 4 can overlap once the change pipeline from phase 3 is stable, since the builder writes through the same pipeline.

Open questions

- [ ] Trial or first-month charge at sign-up, and is a card required before connecting an account?
- [ ] Campaign limits for Growth and Agency.
- [ ] When spend passes the plan limit: warn only, or require an upgrade before more spend?
- [ ] Which change types may auto-apply by default, and is auto-apply on or off for new accounts?
- [ ] Expert sign-off turnaround target and weekend coverage.
- [ ] Which campaign types follow Search in the roadmap: Performance Max or Local Services first?
- [ ] Data residency: one region, or Canada, US and EU regions?
- [ ] Does the Agency plan need a white-label domain at launch or later?

Sources

- Access levels and RMF, Google Ads API documentation
- Required minimum functionality, Google Ads API policy